The Mughals won a quick battle and Baz Bahadur, rather disappointingly for a famous paramour, abandoned Roopmati and fled to Burhanpur. The Mughal takeover of Malwa was particularly harsh. All Baz Bahadur's retinue and wives were taken prisoner as were all his servants and sympathizers. There was to be no clemency for the prisoners, Hindu or Muslim. Adham Khan and Pir Mohammad Khan 'had the captives brought before them, and troop after troop of them put to death, so that their blood flowed river upon river'. Badauni, who appeared to have been present at this gruesome massacre, was horrified. He described the Sayyids and shaikhs pleading for their lives, clutching their Korans in their hands but Pir Muhammad Khan 'put them all to death and burnt them'. When others attempted to stop the murders he told them flippantly that 'in one single night all these captives have been taken, what can be done with them!' As for Roopmati, so far had her fame spread that Adham Khan wanted to see her for himself. Baz Bahadur, however, had left orders for his wives and dancing girls to be killed if ever they were captured. Other reports claimed Roopmati drank poison rather than betray her lover. In either event, Roopmati displayed rather more spirit than her paramour and never was captured by Adham Khan. But Adham Khan did obtain a great deal of buried treasure, elephants, dancing girls, harem girls, precious objects, and 'began to indulge in pleasure' whereas he should have sent everything immediately to the Padshah in Agra.

Instead, Adham Khan sent back to Agra victorious reports of the battle as well as a rather derisory gift of a few elephants. Akbar immediately realized what Adham Khan had done and, in the first instance of decisive action taken entirely independently, decided to confront him. Adham Khan was Akbar's elder koka and had enjoyed a considerable amount of imperial indulgence. But his behaviour in Malwa was a scandalous insult to the dignity of the Padshah and Akbar would no longer tolerate this. Moreover, Akbar had understood the need to check the capricious behaviour of noblemen seeking to assert their independence, and was now starting to take measures to reverse this. Leaving Munim Khan in charge of Agra, a furious Akbar rode out from the city with a small group of elite courtiers without informing any of the nobility. This small group travelled from Agra to Malwa through the rising heat of early summer in just sixteen days. Akbar knew that if he acted quickly, Maham Anaga would have no time to alert her recalcitrant son and warn him of the Padshah's displeasure. Indeed,